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SPW
STUDENT PARTNERSHIP WORLDWIDE INDIA PROJECT TRUST

L'ORÉAL
FUND FOR WOMEN



PROJECT OVERVIEW

Student Partnership Worldwide India Project Trust with support from Loreal Foundation has been working to revolutionize the educational landscape by bringing forth an initiative for creating an impactful experience for students, empowering them with the tools, guidance, and opportunities to explore the realms of science, technology, engineering, and mathematics. The project is implemented in Ganjam district of Odisha State in India.

The key interventions under this project are the following:

1. Identify and ensure that girls especially those at risk of dropping-out are enrolled back to schools.

2. Invest in girls so that they gain critical life skills to boost their self-esteem and confidence so that they make informed choices and are able to negotiate with their gatekeepers.

3. Invest in digital inclusion and improve girls' access to devices and the internet so they can continue their learning and learn about STEM and aspire for further education and career in these fields of studies.

4. Invest in developing critical skills in selected youth leaders to lead on community awareness campaigns aimed at influencing the ecosystem of girls to be more supportive of their education and career choices.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

PROJECT OVERVIEW

QUANTIFIABLE ENGAGEMENT

ACTIVITY BRIEF

HIGHLIGHTS

MAJOR HIGHLIGHTS

Selection and Training of Youth Champions: Young people from the community were selected and trained on STEM Education on developing community awareness campaigns aimed at influencing the ecosystem of girls to be more supportive of their education and career choices



Youth Resource Center Engagement: A Youth Resource Center has been set up with access to computers, books and trained peer educators for community young people to practice the lessons that are taught in schools. Moreover the Youth Resource Centers also provide specially customized trainings for young people that they gain critical life skills to boost their self-esteem and confidence so that they make informed choices and are able to negotiate with their gatekeepers.

Student Profiling: The team first started with collecting basic information about the students of the schools who will be part of the curriculum engagement through our school engagement programs.

School (HM & teacher) Orientation: In order to ensure a smooth implementation and support from the implementing schools HM and Teacher orientation has been initiated where details about the project and the outcome are being shared and an exception is in the form of support from the schools is also discussed.

Curriculum Rollout and Session Engagement with Students: The team of Youth facilitators has initiated curriculum rollout in most of the schools where students are part of the Self modules and at a couple of schools topics under the Gender module have also commenced.

Community Campaigns: The youth champions have also regularly led community campaign to advocate for re enrollment of girls in schools and conducted community events to provide awareness for community members to prevent dropouts of girls from the schools.

Observation of World Youth Skill Day in Colleges and Communities: In order to create awareness of the importance of Girl education and gender discrimination among the youths and community members, we took the opportunity to observe World Youth Skill Day in colleges and a couple of communities across five different locations of Ganjam.





COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

The integration of community engagement within our STEM Education program has proven to be a catalyst for profound and far-reaching impact. By actively involving the community in our educational endeavors, we've unlocked a myriad of opportunities for collaboration, learning, and mutual growth. Through workshops, outreach events, and collaborative projects, we've bridged the gap between the classroom and the community, fostering a deeper understanding of STEM disciplines while simultaneously addressing real-world challenges. This engagement hasn't just enriched the educational experience for students; it has also empowered the community by showcasing the practical applications of STEM, nurturing a culture of innovation, problem-solving, and collective responsibility. The reciprocal exchange of knowledge and resources has not only elevated the quality of our program but has also cultivated a shared sense of purpose, propelling us towards a future where STEM education serves as a cornerstone for community engagement and sustainable progress. Some of the methods that we have used include:



I**nteractive Workshops and Seminars:** Engaged community members, experts, and professionals to share their knowledge and experiences in various STEM fields. These sessions provided valuable insights and learning opportunities for both students and community participants.

Forged Partnerships with Local Businesses and Industries: Collaborated with local businesses and industries to offer hands-on experiences, internships, and mentorship programs to students. These partnerships demonstrated the practical applications of STEM concepts in real-world settings.

Organized STEM Challenges and Competitions: Hosted community-involved challenges addressing local issues, encouraging innovation and problem-solving among participants. These initiatives sparked creativity and showcased the relevance of STEM in addressing societal problems.

Established After-School Programs or Clubs: Created after-school STEM programs or clubs open to community members, providing hands-on activities and projects to foster curiosity and exploration in STEM subjects.

Encouraged Parent and Family Involvement: Organized STEM-related family events or workshops to involve parents and families in students' learning experiences, promoting a positive attitude towards STEM education at home.

Focused on Collaborative Projects Addressing Community Needs: Encouraged students to work on projects that addressed specific local challenges, instilling a sense of responsibility and showcasing the practical applications of STEM knowledge within the community.

SCHOOL ENGAGEMENT



The school engagement initiatives undertaken as part of our STEM program have been instrumental in revolutionizing the educational experience for students. By integrating STEM concepts into the school curriculum and extracurricular activities, we've witnessed a profound shift in students' engagement, enthusiasm, and understanding of these disciplines. Hands-on experiments, interactive projects, and collaborative learning methods have not only made complex STEM subjects more accessible but have also sparked a genuine interest and curiosity among students. This approach has proven incredibly useful in bridging the gap between theoretical knowledge and real-world applications, equipping students with practical skills and problem-solving abilities. Moreover, school engagement in the STEM program has contributed to a more dynamic and interactive classroom environment, fostering a culture of innovation, critical thinking, and active participation among students, ultimately preparing them for success in a rapidly evolving technological landscape. Some of the methods that we have used include

Integrated Curriculum Approach: Aligning STEM concepts within the school's curriculum to infuse science, technology, engineering, and mathematics into various subjects. This method encourages interdisciplinary learning, showcasing the practical applications of STEM in everyday studies.

Hands-On Workshops and Labs: Conducting hands-on workshops and laboratory sessions where students actively engage in experiments, design projects, and problem-solving activities related to STEM topics. These sessions offer practical exposure, fostering a deeper understanding of theoretical concepts.

STEM Clubs and Competitions: Establishing STEM clubs or organizing competitions within the school, encouraging students to explore STEM through innovative projects, challenges, and team-based activities. These initiatives promote teamwork, creativity, and a passion for learning.

Guest Speakers and Industry Visits: Inviting guest speakers, experts, or arranging visits to industries relevant to STEM fields. These interactions provide insights into real-world applications, career pathways, and inspire students by showcasing the diversity within STEM professions.

Teacher Professional Development: Providing professional development opportunities for educators to enhance their knowledge and teaching methodologies in STEM subjects. Equipping teachers with the latest tools and techniques enhances the effectiveness of STEM education delivery.

Youth Resource Center (YRC)

It has been an alternative mode of keeping in touch with some students and also a space where interested students (both from the nearby schools and the communities can develop vocational and technical skills along with recreational activities. The session topics were mostly as per the demands of the parents; on learning Basics of Computers, on learning Basics of Communication and on learning Basic Writing Skills. Students also engaged themselves in some creative activities like Story Writing and Extempore. The Youth Resource Center has also been able to serve has a safe space for young people to come together discuss and plan for the community campaigns. Apart from the Youth engagement activities, we have also been able to host parents, community leaders meeting in the Youth Resource Center. The Youth Resource center also is equipped with books on variety of topics that young people can access.



Recognition and Appreciation

In the last one year our STEM project has received commendation and recognition from the District Education Department. Their appreciation and acknowledgment of the project's significance and impact have been a testament to our dedication and innovation in the field of education. Their approval and permission to expand the implementation of this project across more schools in the district signify a significant milestone, validating the efficacy and value of our STEM initiative. This endorsement reflects not only the quality of our program but also the potential it holds in transforming education by fostering curiosity, critical thinking, and practical application of STEM concepts among students in multiple educational settings within the district. We are honored by their recognition and enthusiastic about the prospect of extending the reach and influence of our project to empower more young minds in the district.

QUANTIFIABLE ENGAGEMENTS

CATEGORY	NUMBER
Youth Engagement	
No of Young Leaders (Girls)	26
No. of Young Leaders (Boys)	7
Schools	
No. of schools where HM & teacher Orientations is accomplished	16
No. Teachers (Female) participated in the Orientation	97
No. Teachers (Male) participated in the Orientation	87
No. of schools where Students engagement is initiated	16
No. of Students (Girls) engaged through session engagements	3262
No. of Students (Boys) engaged through session engagements	1157
No. of Students (Transgenders) engaged through session engagements	0
No. of Students (Specially Abled) engaged through session engagements	3
No. of STEM Clubs formed	5
No. of Students (Girls only) enrolled into STEM Club	213
Community Events / Special Days Observation (World Youth Skill Day 2023, International Youth Day 2023 and World Contraception Day 2023)	
No. of Youths or Young People reached through the event	808
No. of Parents/Community Members reached through the event	2261
No. of Govt. Stakeholders reached through the event	110
No. of External Stakeholders reached through the event	21